Where did my money go?

A Visual Story of U.S. Inflation & Consumer Prices (2015–2025)



Project Scope

For years, every dollar earned has quietly bought less.

This project maps out inflation and its impact on American households between 2015 and 2025.It highlights:

- How prices changed by sector
- How inflation varied by year
- How geography influenced cost of living

The United States economy is one of the largest in the world (World Bank, 2024). This makes it a rich and comprehensive dataset for analysis.

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Why is it Interesting to me?

The value of money is always changing, and it is fascinating to see how much the cost of items have soared over the past decade. This project turns this abstract idea of “inflation” into a visualization.

The project also shows how individuals experience inflation differently in their daily lives, depending on what they buy and where they live.

Consumer Price Index (CPI) data:
U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics

- The Consumer Price Index (CPI) measures how much the average cost of goods and services have changed over time.
- Originally, the downloaded CPI data were in separate Excel sheets, so I combined them into one unified dataset.
- This dataset includes CPI values from 2015 through 2025, across major spending categories: Housing, Transportation, Food, Medical, and Recreation.

A	B	C	D	E
Category	Date	CPI	Country	
Food	2025-04-01	334.918	USA	
Food	2025-05-01	335.687	USA	
Food	2025-06-01	336.555	USA	
Food	2025-07-01	337.077	USA	
Food	2025-08-01	338.366	USA	
Food	2025-09-01	339.443	USA	
Food	2025-11-01	338.857	USA	
Food	2025-12-01	340.78	USA	
Housing	2015-01-01	235.485	USA	
Housing	2015-02-01	236.016	USA	
Housing	2015-03-01	236.435	USA	
Housing	2015-04-01	236.777	USA	
Housing	2015-05-01	237.175	USA	
Housing	2015-06-01	238.568	USA	
Housing	2015-07-01	239.085	USA	

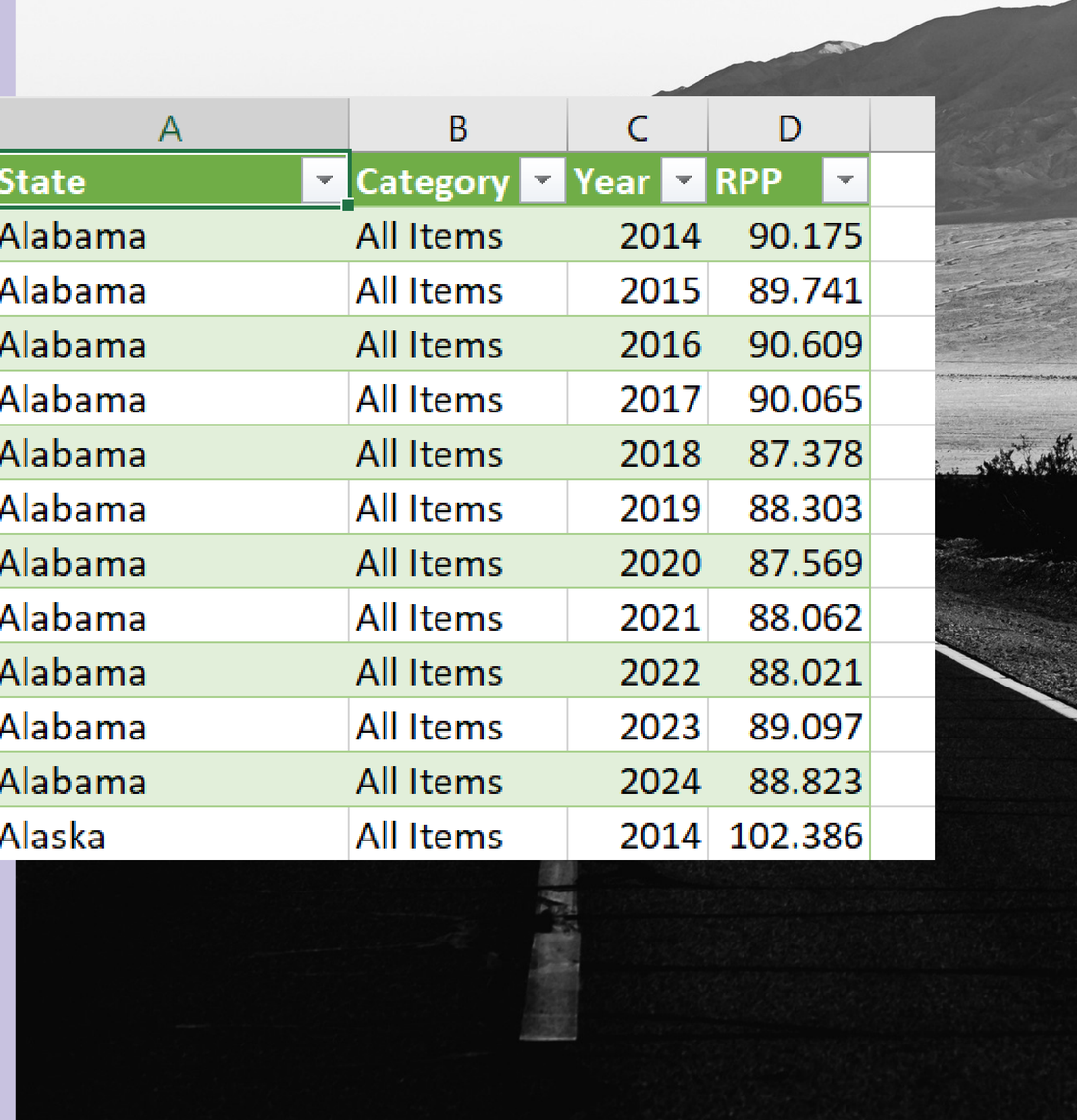
Regional Price Parities by State data:
Bureau of Economic Analysis

- This dataset contains Regional Price Parity (RPP) values for every U.S. state from 2014 to 2024.

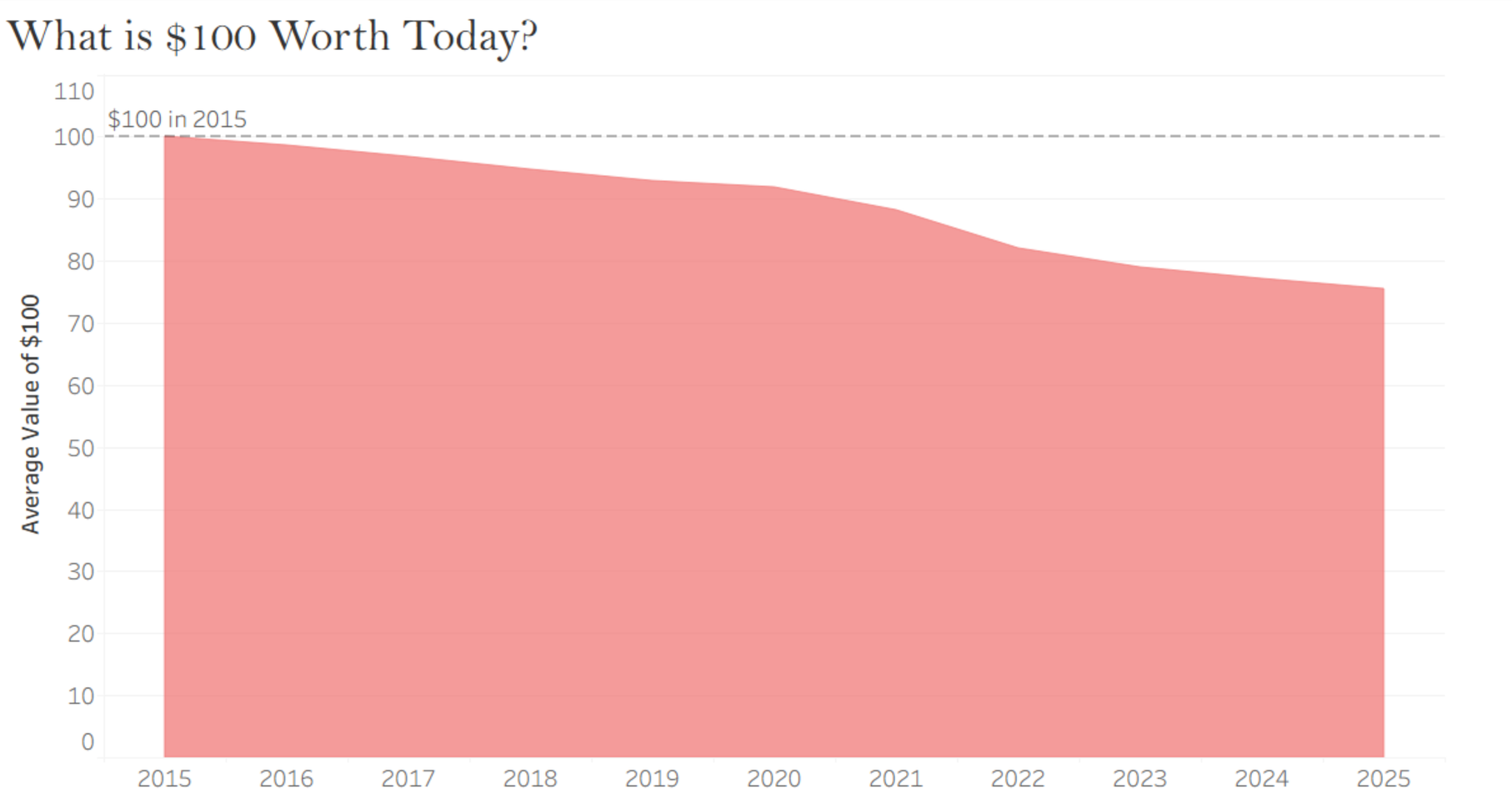
- RPP measures how expensive it is to live in each state relative to the national average (100).
  - RPP > 100 = more expensive than the U.S. average
  - RPP < 100 = cheaper than the U.S. average

- Each row includes state, category, year and RPP value

	A	B	C	D
1	State	Category	Year	RPP
2	Alabama	All Items	2014	90.175
3	Alabama	All Items	2015	89.741
4	Alabama	All Items	2016	90.609
5	Alabama	All Items	2017	90.065
6	Alabama	All Items	2018	87.378
7	Alabama	All Items	2019	88.303
8	Alabama	All Items	2020	87.569
9	Alabama	All Items	2021	88.062
10	Alabama	All Items	2022	88.021
11	Alabama	All Items	2023	89.097
12	Alabama	All Items	2024	88.823
13	Alaska	All Items	2014	102.386



How much is $100 from 2015 worth today ?



Purchasing power of $100 (2015)

~$73

in 2025 dollars (all items)

You'd need today to match $100 in 2015

~$137

All items CPI-adjusted

Which spending areas were hit the hardest?

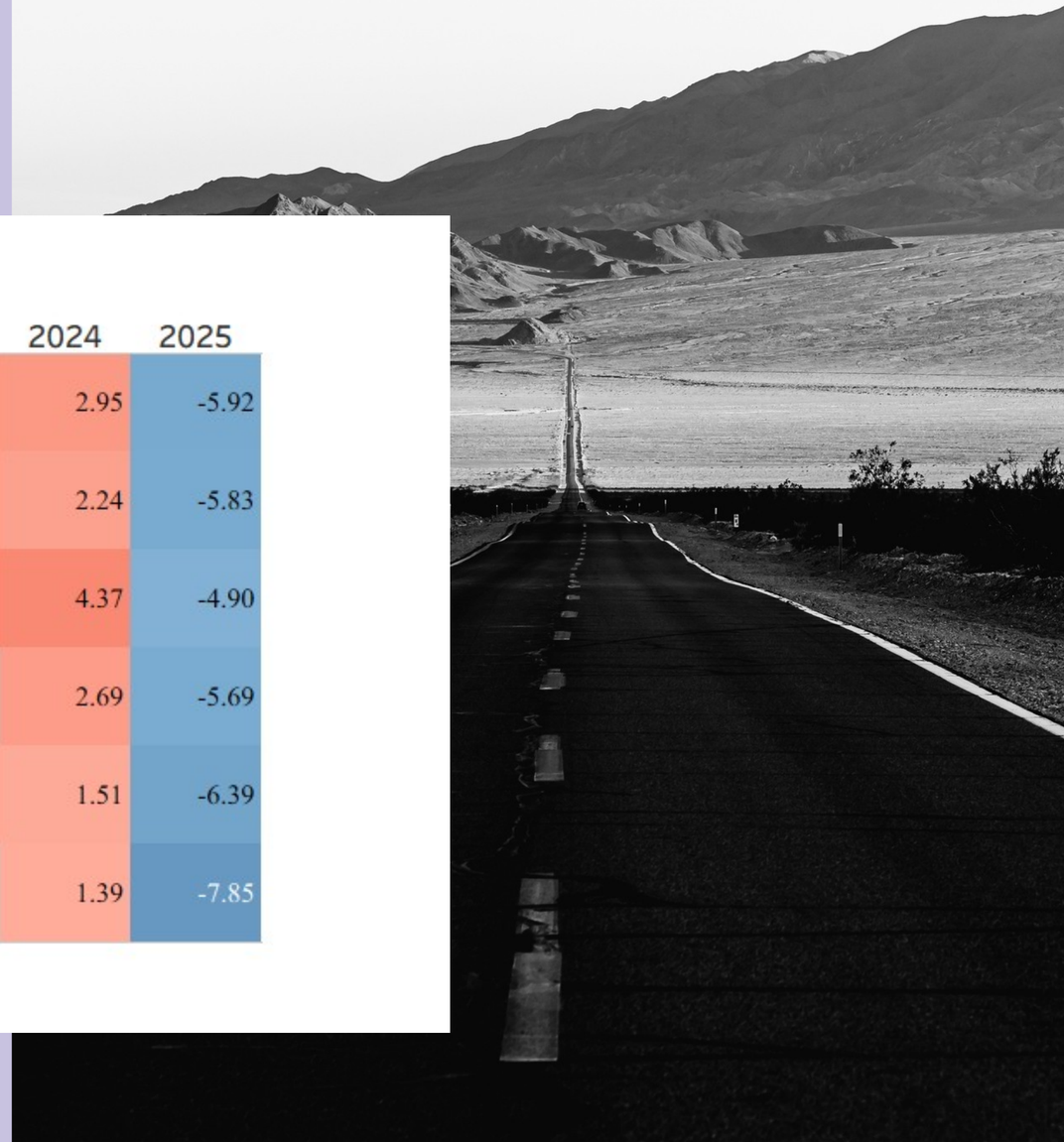


Timeline Visualization

The icons drain as inflation depreciates what $1 buys.
2015 Baseline = 100%

$1 buys only 68 cents worth of housing today compared to 2015.

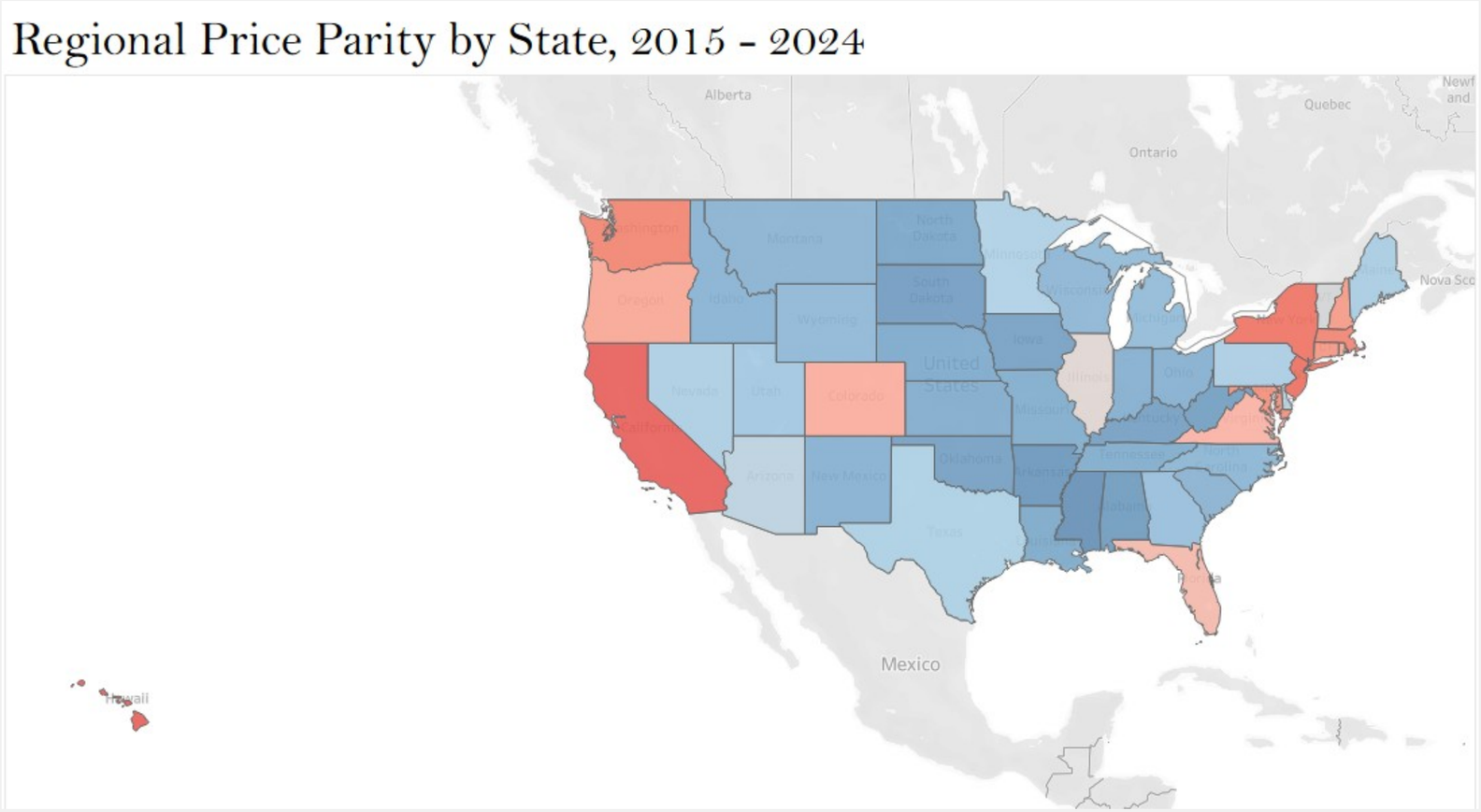
Which spending areas were hit the hardest?



YoY Change %

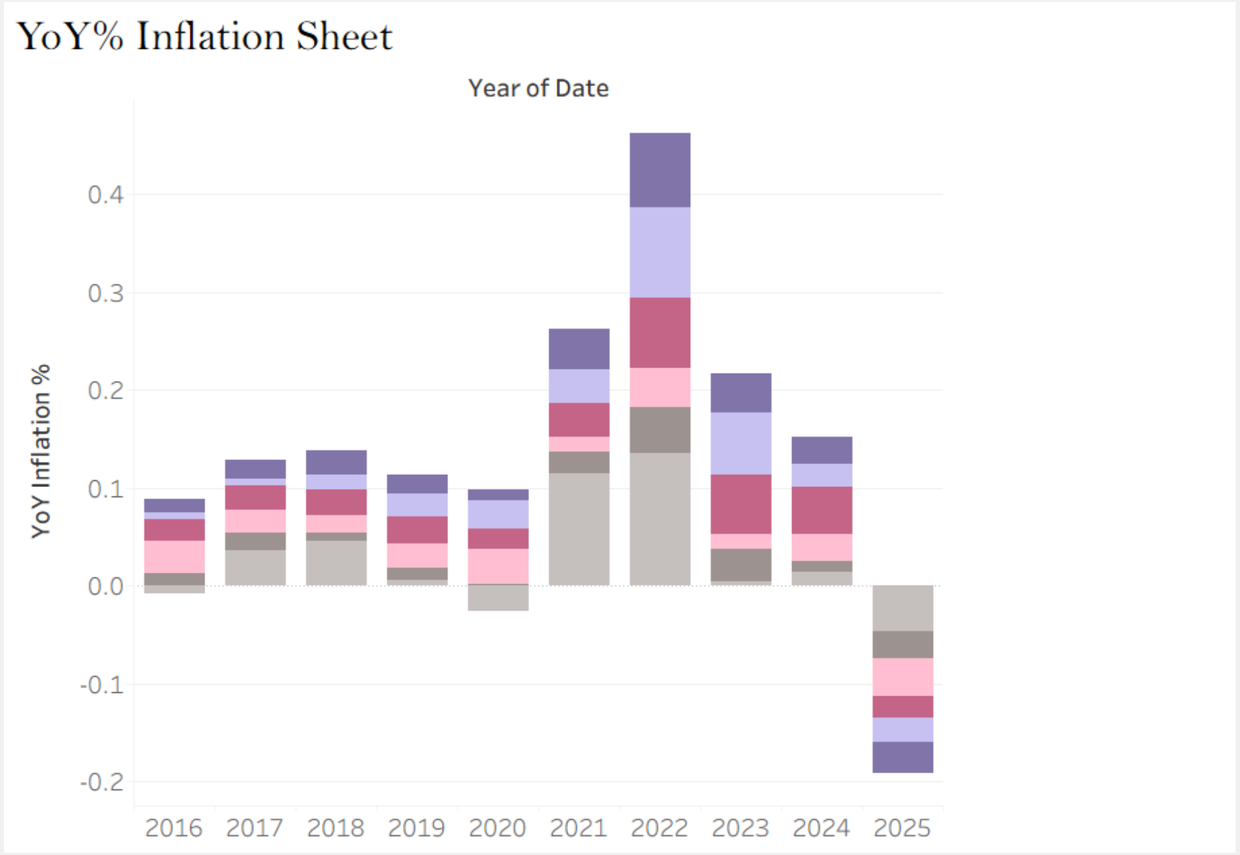
Category	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
All Items	1.26	2.13	2.44	1.81	1.23	4.70	8.00	4.12	2.95	-5.92
Food	0.34	0.88	1.40	1.84	3.34	3.82	9.58	5.66	2.24	-5.83
Housing	2.48	2.97	2.89	2.89	2.19	3.29	7.15	6.44	4.37	-4.90
Medical care	3.79	2.51	1.97	2.83	4.11	1.23	4.05	0.46	2.69	-5.69
Recreation	0.90	1.30	0.50	1.28	1.35	2.40	4.53	4.02	1.51	-6.39
Transportation	-2.10	3.42	4.51	-0.28	-4.16	14.56	15.47	0.24	1.39	-7.85

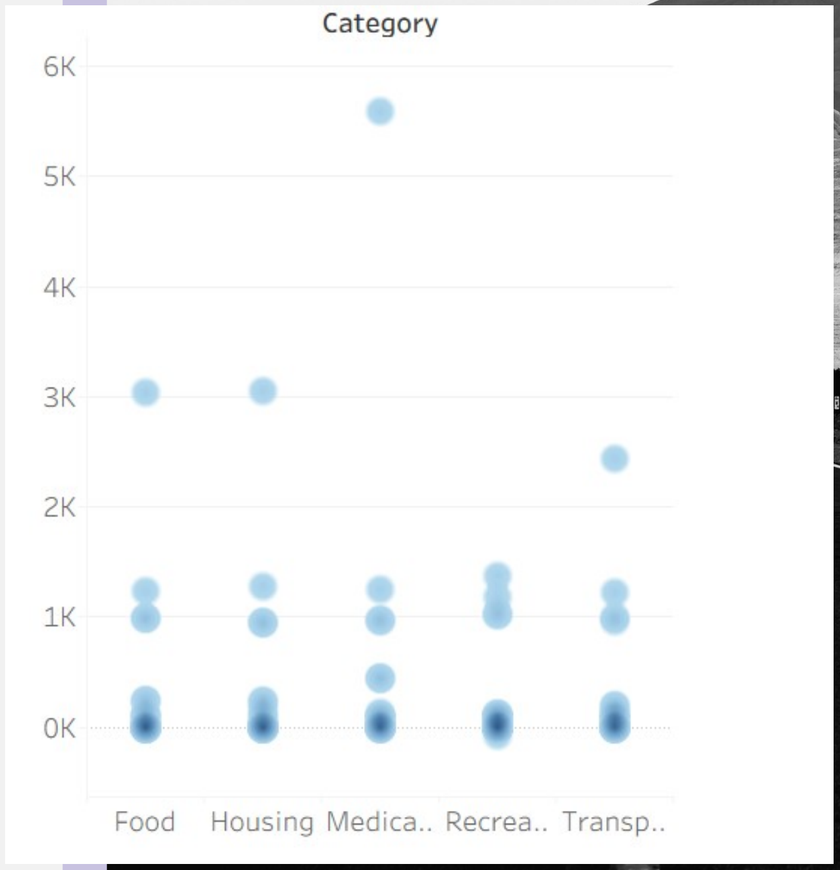
Where you live matters



California	110.7
Hawaii	110.0
Washington DC	109.9
New Jersey	108.8
New York	107.9
Arkansas	86.9
Mississippi	87.0
Iowa	87.8
Oklahoma	87.8

Other Visualizations





Trends

- Housing has been impacted most by inflation this past decade.
- Global supply chain disruptions after COVID-19 contributed to the rapid rise in U.S. inflation.
- Recreation has seen the least impact.

Conclusion

- Inflation was mostly dormant pre-2020 but proved highly sensitive to economic shocks.
- Energy, food, and housing (shelter) remain the biggest drivers of overall inflation.

Thank You

